

HEALTHFIRST INSURANCE

Medical Policy: MSK-2026-LSP

Section 4.2 Lumbar Spine MRI Coverage Criteria

MRI Lumbar Spine may be considered medically necessary when ALL of the following conditions are met:

1. Symptoms persist for six weeks or longer.
2. Conservative treatment has failed, including one or more of the following:
 3. Physical therapy
 4. Medication management
 5. Home exercise program
6. Patient demonstrates one or more neurological findings:
 7. Numbness
 8. Tingling
 9. Weakness
10. Radicular pain
11. Ordering physician documents medical necessity.

Documentation Requirements:

Progress notes

Treatment history

Physician recommendation

Diagnostic rationale